

Scene 1

Orbard of OLIVER's house

(Enter ORLANDO and ADAM)

ORLANDO

As I remember, Adam, it was upon this fashion bequeathed me by will but poor a thousand crowns, and, as thou sayst, charged my brother on his blessing to breed me well. And there begins my sadness. My brother Jaques he keeps at school, and report speaks goldenly of his profit. For my part, he keeps me rustically at home, or, to speak more properly, stays me here at home unkept; for call you that 'keeping,' for a gentleman of my birth, that differs not from the stalling of an ox? His horses are bred better, for, besides that they are fair with their feeding, they are taught their manage and, to that end, riders dearly hired. But I, his brother, gain nothing under him but growth, for the which his animals on his dunghills are as much bound to him as I. Besides this nothing that he so plentifully gives me, the something that nature gave me his countenance seems to take from me. He lets me feed with his hinds, bars me the place of a brother, and, as much as in him lies, mines my gentility with my education. This is it, Adam, that grieves me, and the spirit of my father, which I think is within me, begins to mutiny against this servitude. I will no longer endure it, though yet I know no wise remedy how to avoid it.

(Enter OLIVER)

ADAM

Yonder comes my master, your brother.

ORLANDO

Go apart, Adam, and thou shalt hear how he will shake me up.

(ADAM steps aside.)

OLIVER

Now, sir, what make you here?

ORLANDO

Nothing. I am not taught to make anything.

OLIVER

What mar you then, sir?

ORLANDO

Marry, sir, I am helping you to mar that which God made, a poor unworthy brother of yours, with idleness.

OLIVER

Marry, sir, be better employed, and be naught awhile.

ORLANDO

Shall I keep your hogs and eat husks with them? What prodigal portion have I spent that I should come to such penury?

OLIVER

Know you where you are, sir?

ORLANDO

O, sir, very well: here in your orchard.

OLIVER

Know you before whom, sir?

ORLANDO

Ay, better than him I am before knows me. I know you are my eldest brother, and in the gentle condition of blood you should so know me. The courtesy of nations allows you my better in that you are the first-born, but the same tradition takes not away my blood, were there twenty brothers betwixt us. I have as much of my father in me as you, albeit I confess your coming before me is nearer to his reverence.



OLIVER

(Threatening ORLANDO)
What, boy!

ORLANDO

(Holding off OLIVER by the throat)
Come, come, elder brother, you are too young in this.

OLIVER

Wilt thou lay hands on me, villain?

ORLANDO

I am no villain. I am the youngest son of Sir Rowland de Boys. He was my father, and he is thrice a villain that says such a father begot villains. Wert thou not my brother, I would not take this hand from thy throat till this other had pulled out thy tongue for saying so. Thou hast railed on thyself.

ADAM

(Coming forward)
Sweet masters, be patient. For your father's remembrance, be at accord.

OLIVER

(To ORLANDO)
Let me go, I say.

ORLANDO

I will not till I please. You shall hear me. My father charged you in his will to give me good education. You have trained me like a peasant, obscuring and hiding from me all gentlemanlike qualities. The spirit of my father grows strong in me, and I will no longer endure it. Therefore allow me such exercises as may become a gentleman, or give me the poor allottery my father left me by testament. With that I will go buy my fortunes.

(ORLANDO releases OLIVER)

OLIVER

And what wilt thou do—beg when that is spent? Well, sir, get you in. I will not long be troubled with you. You shall have some part of your will. I pray you leave me.

ORLANDO

I will no further offend you than becomes me for my good.

OLIVER

(To ADAM)

Get you with him, you old dog.

ADAM

Is 'old dog' my reward? Most true, I have lost my teeth in your service. God be with my old master. He would not have spoke such a word.

(Exit ORLANDO and ADAM)

OLIVER

Is it even so? Begin you to grow upon me? I will physic your rankness, and yet give no thousand crowns neither.—Holla, Dennis!

(Enter DENNIS)

DENNIS

Calls your Worship?

OLIVER

Was not Charles, the Duke's wrestler, here to speak with me?

DENNIS

So please you, he is here at the door and importunes access to you.

OLIVER

Call him in.

(Exit DENNIS)

"I will be a good way, and tomorrow the wrestling is.

CORIN, a shepherd

SILVIUS, a young shepherd in love

PHOEBE, a disdainful shepherdess

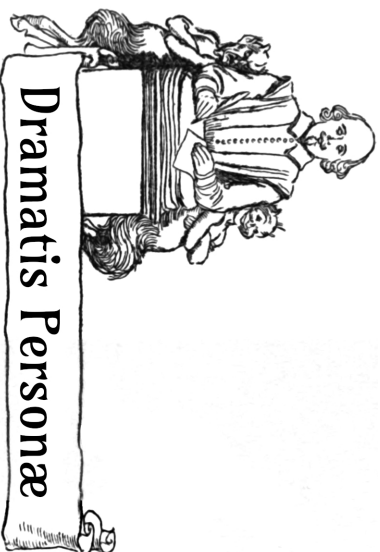
AUDREY, a goat-keeper

WILLIAM, a country youth in love with AUDREY

SIR OLIVER MARTEXT, a parish priest

HYMEN, god of marriage

LORDS, ATTENDANTS, AND MUSICIANS



ORLANDO, youngest son of Sir Rowland de Boys	
OLIVER, his elder brother	
SECOND BROTHER, brother to ORLANDO and OLIVER, named] Jaques	
ADAM, servant to OLIVER and friend to ORLANDO	
DENNIS, servant to OLIVER	
ROSALIND, daughter to DUKE SENIOR	
CELIA, cousin to ROSALIND and daughter to DUKE FREDERICK	
TOUCHSTONE, a court Fool	
DUKE FREDERICK, the usurping duke	
CHARLES, wrestler at DUKE FREDERICK's court	
LE BEAU, a courtier at DUKE FREDERICK's court	
FIRST LORD	} Lords attending DUKE FREDERICK
SECOND LORD	
DUKE SENIOR, the exiled duke, brother to DUKE FREDERICK	
JAQUES	} Lords attending DUKE SENIOR in exile
AMIENS	
FIRST LORD	
SECOND LORD	
FIRST PAGE	} Pages attending DUKE SENIOR in exile
SECOND PAGE	

(Enter CHARLES)

CHARLES

Good morrow to your Worship.

OLIVER

Good Monsieur Charles, what's the new news at the new court?

CHARLES

There's no news at the court, sir, but the old news. That is, the old duke is banished by his younger brother the new duke, and three or four loving lords have put themselves into voluntary exile with him, whose lands and revenues enrich the new duke. Therefore he gives them good leave to wander.

OLIVER

Can you tell if Rosalind, the Duke's daughter, be banished with her father?

CHARLES

O, no, for the Duke's daughter her cousin so loves her, being ever from their cradles bred together, that she would have followed her exile or have died to stay behind her. She is at the court and no less beloved of her uncle than his own daughter, and never two ladies loved as they do.

OLIVER

Where will the old duke live?

CHARLES

They say he is already in the Forest of Arden, and a many merry men with him; and there they live like the old Robin Hood of England. They say many young gentlemen flock to him every day and fleet the time carelessly, as they did in the golden world.

OLIVER

What, you wrestle tomorrow before the new duke?

CHARLES

Marry, do I, sir, and I came to acquaint you with a matter. I am given, sir, secretly to understand that your younger brother Orlando hath a disposition to come in disguised against me to try a fall. Tomorrow, sir, I wrestle for my credit, and he that escapes me without some broken limb shall acquit him well. Your brother is but young and tender, and for your love I would be loath to foil him, as I must for my own honour if he come in. Therefore, out of my love to you, I came hither to acquaint you withal, that either you might stay him from his intendment, or brook such disgrace well as he shall run into, in that it is a thing of his own search and altogether against my will.

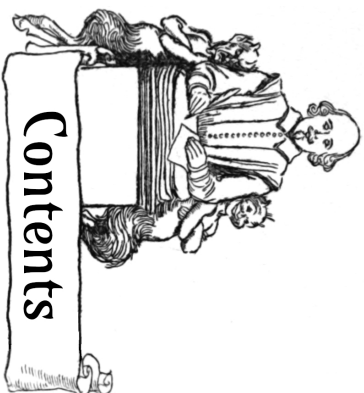
OLIVER

Charles, I thank thee for thy love to me, which thou shalt find I will most kindly requite. I had myself notice of my brother's purpose herein, and have by underhand means laboured to dissuade him from it; but he is resolute. I'll tell thee, Charles, it is the stubbornest young fellow of France, full of ambition, an envious emulator of every man's good parts, a secret and villainous contriver against me his natural brother. Therefore use thy discretion. I had as lief thou didst break his neck as his finger. And thou wert best look to 't, for if thou dost him any slight disgrace, or if he do not mightily grace himself on thee, he will practice against thee by poison, entrap thee by some treacherous device, and never leave thee till he hath ta'en thy life by some indirect means or other. For I assure thee—and almost with tears I speak it—there is not one so young and so villainous this day living. I speak but brotherly of him, but should I anatomize him to thee as he is, I must blush and weep, and thou must look pale and wonder.

CHARLES

I am heartily glad I came hither to you. If he come tomorrow, I'll give him his payment. If ever he go alone again, I'll never wrestle for prize more. And so God keep your Worship.

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OLIVER

Farewell, good Charles.

(Exit CHARLES)

Now will I stir this gamester. I hope I shall see an end of him, for my soul—yet I know not why—hates nothing more than he. Yet he's gentle, never schooled and yet learned, full of noble device, of all sorts enchantingly beloved, and indeed so much in the heart of the world, and especially of my own people, who best know him, that I am altogether misprized. But it shall not be so long; this wrestler shall clear all. Nothing remains but that I kindle the boy thither, which now I'll go about.

(Exeunt)



I PRAY THEE, BE MERRY

